

Usability Study | Docket Clerks

Washington, DC
January 16, 2020

Study Information

In this study, Flexion UX Designers observed Docket Clerks performing their normal job functions to test end-to-end processes using the new CMS.

Participants

- 3 Docket Clerks

Sessions

All participants were observed at their own workspaces at the U.S. Tax Court. Participants, used desktop computers, dual monitors and scanners.

Key Findings

- Docket Clerks were able to perform most of their normal job functions using the new CMS
- Docket Clerks were able to use scanning functionality, including flatbed, single, and double-sided document
- There is a concern about having multiple service dates due to the change to real-time service of electronic documents; we need to ensure that paper documents are mailed the same date as electronic documents were served
- The MVP solution for consolidated cases was a big concern for clerks, as it will change their current processes and require duplicate work; a better understanding of the workaround for court-issued documents would be beneficial

Recommendations

Service

- Process concern: May need a service cut off time or warning for cases with paper service; cannot serve some parties electronically and not mail the paper documents on the same date
- Need ability to serve documents that are manually added to the docket record
- Need ability to select which parties were served / to be served

Messages

- Once a message is sent, keep user on the Document Detail screen

Orders

- Update generic “O” Order description field to text area field so users can view more text at once
- On Save on Create Order screen, update navigation to take user directly to the Draft Order screen
- Update language on button label to “Save and Serve”
- Co-locate Docket Entry Preview with the order description fields

Recommendations

Document QC

- Move Create PDF above the scanned image preview
- Consider a cover sheet preview (Post-MVP)

Docket Record Minute Entries

- Docket clerks need the ability to select whether a minute entry should be created when certain actions are taken (filing fees paid, address changes, etc.) (learned behavior)

Consolidated Cases

- Better understand and document the MVP work-around process regarding documents filed into consolidated cases and court-issued documents impacting consolidated cases (educational)

Filing Parties

- Add ability to select “Third Party” as a filing party
- Consider logic to automatically add “Joint” to jointly filed documents (Post-MVP)

Recommendations (Design Clean Up)

- Move create pdf button above quick view
- Weird wrapping of case status/judge/blocked
- In Progress Message - would like to see if message is new/unread - there is no indicator/bolding on this list
- Due date - error message when entering two digit -wasn't sure what she needed to do to resolve the error- need helper text for date format
- Order draft - title doesn't need to be in all caps - also consider placement of "Draft"
- A lot of space below COS and Who Is fling on Document QC
- Pending Report- Judge column wrapping, column should be wider so does not wrap
- Pending Report - Filter - change default to "See All"
- Pending Report - Chief Judge vs. Chief Judge Foley
- May want to add the "Add Deadline" and "Add Note" to the actual tab - people expect to be able to perform that action from the specific tab (in addition to the global actions)
- Success messages are way too big- consider redesign

Findings | Comprehensive Findings

Findings

Service

- Process concern: May need a service cut off time or warning for cases with paper service; cannot serve some parties electronically and not mail the paper documents on the same date
- Any docket change or addition needs service with selection of what parties
- Need ability to SERVE - when adding paper documents
 - Need ability to select who is being served
 - Need date for paper service - cannot put in mail on a date that is not the served date
 - Need ability to only serve opposing parties - filing party does not need to be served
- E-filed answer - with CS - showing as served to Both
 - If there is a CS - it doesn't need to be served again

Findings

Document QC/ Add Docket Entry

- Confused about “Add to Cover Sheet” because they currently have to add the cover sheet themselves
- Able to scan flatbed no problems
- Able to change scanners and settings
- Expected that when she selected Filing party as the wife, that would display in the docket entry as the change of address as “for Ashley”
- Important for clerk to see what the cover sheet looks like and the docket entry
- Move Create PDF above the preview

Messages

- After sending message - takes you out of the entire cases - not expected behavior

Findings

Orders

- Order- text box needs to be a text-area to display more information
- On an answer when have cos do not need service
- Create Order - once saved should go directly to Draft Order screen to apply signature/send message/etc.
- Unsure of difference between Save and Serve to Parties
- Order add docket entry - need better way to display docket entry preview- unclear to clerk that this is the entry and what the final entry will look

Minute Entries

- Notice of change of address flow - totally weird- duplicate when received paper filing
 - Filed by party - showing docket clerk's name
 - Would expect this to be a minute entry "Address was changed" -if any minute

Findings

Trial Location

- Organized by city, not state currently, but had no issue locating the correct trial location

Consolidated Cases

- Motion to Consolidate
 - Motion needs to be filed in all cases
 - Orders granting need to be filed in all cases
 - Would judge's need to put all of the docket number on their orders if they are being manually filed In each consolidated case

Filing Parties

- Joint filed documents - says "Joint Status Report" on cover
 - Applied to any document where all parties are filing jointly
 - They still have to look for signatures, and could correct the filing parties and have to issue a new cover sheet
 - Need a 3rd party unspecified under who is filing the document

Findings

Bugs

- Search for case- 1st time no results (could not reproduce)
- Display of pdf hit or miss, sometimes displays sometimes does not (Added to Trello)
- Select recipient field for message- have to click on Select to show dropdown - should be able to click anywhere on the field (could not reproduce)
- Draft orders not always showing the correct screen (Added to Trello)
- Edit Case Status - dropdown should display the current status (could not reproduce)
- When you add spouse (changing party type) -system is generates Notice of Change of Address automatically - which does not need to be done - no minute entry needed (Added to Trello)
- QC complete is prompting paper service modal and should not be (Added to Trello)

Findings

Design updates

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Questions | Come on, let us have 'em!

Appendix